

Jesus Never Fails

“On your mark Beep”

Ana dived into the clear crystal pool. It was the 200m backstroke event. Not only was she oblivious

to the cheering and noise of the spectators but also to the swimmers on her left and right. Her aim was

to stay focused, do her best and win. And win she did! She won the event and unbelievably smashed

the five-year record. The swim had seemed so easy to her. All the hard work had paid off.

She climbed out of the pool and only then did she hear the ecstatic screams and cheering.

“Samoa... Samoa.”

The noise jolted her back to reality. Members of the Samoa swim team ran and hugged her.

“You won, Ana! You won! You also broke the record”.

Really? Did I win? Broke the record? She thought to herself.

She looked around as if searching for somebody. Where is Lani? she thought to herself.

Lani was the other Samoan swimmer in the event. Both of them had been selected to represent

Samoa in the 200m backstroke event in the Oceania Competition in Wellington. They had started

swimming at five and were in the same swim club. She then noticed Lani walking towards the group.

A few of the Samoa swim team members hugged and praised her for her efforts. She had come 5th.

But what struck Ana was Lani’s attitude. She did not even smile, congratulate nor hug her as she

used to back home whenever Ana won an event. Lani completely ignored her. Ana felt confused and

and sad. She almost wished she had not won the 200m backstroke. Maybe, she would congratulate

me later in our hotel room, she thought to herself.

At the end of the day, the team boarded a chartered bus back to the hotel. Ana had expected Lani

to sit next to her just as they had sat together on the way to the pool. But no, she did not give Ana a

glance as she moved past her. If any of the team members had noticed something unusual about it,

no one had commented at all. For a moment, she forgot about Lani as the bus travelled through the

city. She admired the tall buildings, the busy streets, the whole surrounding which was so different

from the small town of Apia.

Ana dreaded reaching the hotel because she and Lani shared a room. However, she decided to

ask Lani why she was ignoring her. Several of the team members got in the lift with her and Lani.

It was fun being in the lift. She rarely had opportunities to go on the lift in Apia as there were a few.

Lani entered their room first and went straight into the bathroom. Ana tried to think of what to

say as she waited for her to come out.

“La...” She couldn’t continue as Lani cut through her words.

“Don’t talk to me. I hate you! You got all the attention at the pool. Nobody paid attention to me,” Lani screamed at her.

“But I thought you...” Ana didn’t finish what she was saying for Lani turned and left the room.

Ana stood rooted to the spot, too shocked to say or do anything. After several seconds, she sat

on her bed and sadly remembered all the happy moments they had spent together back home in

Apia. They had been more than friends. Apart from being in the same swim team, they also go to

the same school and in the same class.

That evening, Ana didn't go for dinner. She called her parents and told them about Lani's strange

attitude.

"Ana, remember. Share your problems to Jesus no matter how small and trivial it may seem to

you," her mother advised.

Before Lani returned, Ana poured out her heart to Jesus and asked Him to set their relationship

right as before. Lani returned and got into bed without saying 'goodnight'. Ana felt upset but she

knew that talking to her would be useless. She turned away from Lani and asked God to fill her with

peace and thanked Him that everything would be alright the following morning.

In the morning, Lani was still sleeping when Ana got out of bed and went to shower. As soon as

she came out of the bathroom, Lani got out of her bed and hugged her.

"I'm so sorry, Ana. I'm really sorry for the way I treated you. I guess I was jealous for all the attention you received."

Ana hugged her back and told her that the win was for her and all the others. They stood embraced

for a few seconds and as Ana looked out of the window, she murmured, “Thank you, Jesus.”

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App 650 words